Ford Motor Company

November 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S41:** Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln Town Car Vehicles – Seat Belt Inspection

REF #1: Dealer Announcement dated May 10, 1999, Low Volume Recalls and Owner Notification Programs (Attachment IV)

REF #2: Dealer Announcement dated December 17, 1998, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment V)

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 model year Lincoln Town Car vehicles built at the Wixom Assembly Plant from July 31, 2000 through August 2, 2000.

NON-COMPLIANCE

In some of the affected vehicles an incorrect driver's (left) side rear seat belt and retractor assembly may have been unintentionally installed. This seat belt has not been certified to the applicable requirements of FMVSS 209 with the installed buckle.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must inspect the seat belt tongue and, if necessary, replace the seat belt and retractor assembly. This must be completed on all of the affected vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

LOW VOLUME RECALL

This recall is being processed as a Low Volume Recall. This type of field action was announced in an All-Dealer letter dated May 10, 1999. (See Attachment IV)

Owners will be contacting the Low Volume Recall Coordination Center to arrange for this service. We will advise you via MORS III of the owners that chose your dealership to perform the service provided by this Recall program. The parts will be ordered for you by the Program Coordination Center.

Please Note: Only some of the affected vehicles will actually require a seat belt retractor replacement. However, to minimize customer inconvenience, a replacement part will be sent for each affected vehicle that is identified to the Coordination Center. If inspection reveals that the part is not required, it may be returned for credit.

You are requested to contact the owner and arrange for this service. (Note that our Coordination Center will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days.)

LINCOLN COMMITMENT SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Lincoln owners affected by this recall. Please see dealer announcement dated December 17, 1998, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment V). The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer Lincoln owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Lincoln Town Car customers, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: Low Volume Dealer Announcement Letter
Attachment V: Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure Announcement Letter
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS ?

Claims Information:……1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S41
Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln Town Car Vehicles
Seat Belt Inspection

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

You must contact the Low Volume Recall Coordination Center at 1-800-325-5621 to arrange for parts if you have an involved vehicle in stock. When calling this number, identify Safety Recall 00S41 and have the VIN of the dealer stock vehicle to be serviced.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

When you receive notification through MORS III, you should contact the owner and arrange for this service. Please note that our Coordination Center will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days. For more information, see attached copy of "Low Volume Announcement Letter" dated May 10,1999.

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

Note: Owners should receive the " Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure". Before calling Lincoln Town Car owners, review Attachment V to familiarize yourself with this special handling procedure.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- To claim for the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of Attachment V.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer.) Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are approved per guidelines in "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", Attachment V.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S41
Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln Town Car Vehicles
Seat Belt Inspection

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect	00S41A	0.2 Hours
Inspect and Replace Seat Belt Retractor Assembly	00S41B	0.4 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling:	Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"	See Attachment V

* Lincoln Commitment Special Handling does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

CUSTOMER VEHICLES:

Parts will be shipped to your dealership according to the procedures established for "Low Volume Recalls". DO NOT order parts, except for dealer stock units (Refer to Attachment IV).

Note: When the customer calls the Coordination Center, the correct parts will be automatically sent to the dealer. This will avoid having the customer return to the dealer if the vehicle fails the inspection. Parts not used may be returned for credit. (See "Excess Stock Return" below).

STOCK VEHICLES:

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. First, inspect all affected stock vehicles to determine parts requirements. Then, contact the Low Volume Recall Coordination Center at 1-800-325-5621 to arrange for parts. When calling this number, identify Safety Recall 00S41 and have the VIN of the dealer stock vehicle to be serviced.

All Orders	Before December 23, 2000	Call 1-800-325-5621
All Orders	After December 23, 2000	Normal Order Process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
XW1Z-54611B69-AAE	Rear Seat Belt and Retractor Assembly – Midnight Black	1
XW1Z-54611B69-AAB	Rear Seat Belt and Retractor Assembly – Medium Parchment	1

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50192 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

May 10, 1999

To: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

cc: All Parts Managers
All Service Managers

Subject: Updated Part Procurement Process For Low Volume Recalls

The purpose of this communication is to update the process for dealer acquisition of service parts for certain Recalls/Owner Notification Programs with a small number of involved vehicles.

Background:

- Situations where Recalls/Owner Notification Programs have a small number of involved units require special handling.
- There are no controls in the parts system to prevent the over-ordering of parts in low volume situations.
- Many dealers order one or more parts even if they do not have an involved unit to insure customer satisfaction. This can result in parts in the inventory of dealers who do not need them and exhausted supply for dealers who do need them.
- With existing procedures, there is a cost to the Company and the Dealers (handling, returning, scrapping, etc.).

What's "Small Volume"?

- Generally, recalls, or ONP's involving 5,000 or fewer vehicles.

What We Propose

- Procedure to better manage "Parts-To-Affected-Vehicle" process.
- Vehicle owner (retail customer/fleet/dealer) requested to contact a "process facilitator" via a special 1-800 toll-free line or with a special postcard provided with the owner letter.
- Process facilitator verifies VIN/Owner information and works with owner (or dealer) to identify repairing dealer.
- Process facilitator inputs part order and sends a MORS III message with Customer/VIN/part shipping information to the identified repairing dealer.
- Dealer would be charged for the part at the lowest acquisition cost.

What's Different:

- Owner asked to call special toll-free line or send back special postcard.
- Parts would not be available through the normal parts ordering system.
- Owners would need to have an appointment.

Dealer Benefits:

- Eliminates back-orders—guarantees part availability.
- Increases customer satisfaction with your "Service Experience"
- New process will enable dealers to initiate pro-active service scheduling—with the information we will provide on the MORS III message, you call the customers to arrange a service appointment knowing that the part will be there and the customer's vehicle needs service.

Additional details will be provided as specific Recalls/Owner Notification Programs suitable for this process are launched.

We ask that you share this procedure with your parts and service personnel to insure they are aware of this process.

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

R. E. Turecki
Director
Global Parts Supply and Logistics

Program Announcement Letter
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling

Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 17, 1998

To: All Lincoln Mercury and Ford Dealers

cc: Parts Managers
Service Managers

Subject: Announcing Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure for Certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs

As part of our ongoing commitment to Lincoln customers, we are pleased to announce the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure to provide additional dealer compensation for certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs(ONP's) that affect Lincoln brand vehicles.

This additional compensation is being provided to allow dealers to provide personalized service designed to make the recall repair a positive experience for the Lincoln customer, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

Each Recall/ONP Bulletin affecting Lincoln vehicles will indicate whether the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure is authorized; please note that not every Recall/ONP will qualify for this procedure and that the procedure will not be communicated to customers as a normal benefit of the Lincoln Commitment Program. Special handling and claiming instructions are included on the attached page. This program will apply only to Lincoln vehicles which have been delivered to customers.

We ask you to make maximum usage of these special enhancements to the Lincoln Commitment Program when applicable. Thank you in advance for your support of this program and our commitment to surprise and delight our Lincoln customers.

/O.S.B./
Mark Hutchins
President
Lincoln Mercury

/O.S.B./
M. D. Jordan
Executive Director
Ford Customer Service Division
North America

If Dealer Picks up and Returns Vehicle for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair* • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $58/hour and fuel cost of $1.05/gallon): 1.2 hrs. labor* = $69.60 9.0 gals fuel = 9.45 Wash/vacuum = 3.50 Total Submitted = $82.55 *travel time+fueling/washing labor
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $28 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $28 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle	Up to 0.5 hour additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

November 2000

00S41

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a seat belt in certain 2000 Lincoln Town Car vehicles may fail to conform to the requirements specified in the Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standard No. 209, Seat Belt Assemblies.

We apologize for this inconvenience and want to assure you that we are dedicated to maintaining your Lincoln Town Car as an exceptional vehicle. Our commitment, together with your dealer, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the non-compliance is…	In some of the affected vehicles an incorrect driver's side rear seat belt and retractor assembly may have been unintentionally installed. The incorrect seat belt has not been certified to the requirements of FMVSS 209 with the installed seat belt buckle.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...	Ford Motor Company will inspect your vehicle free of charge and, if necessary, replace the affected seat belt and retractor assembly. Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to call: 1-800-248-0186 to arrange for this seat belt inspection.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do…

Call toll-free 1-800-248-0186 and inform the Ford representative that you wish to have your vehicle serviced under Safety Recall 00S41. Representatives are available 7:30AM to 7:30PM Monday through Friday, and 8:00AM to 3:00PM on Saturday (times are Eastern Time).

Please have this letter with you when you call. The Ford representative will ask for the serial number of your vehicle. The serial number is printed on the top of this letter.

Arrangements will be made with the dealership of your choice to have parts available. The dealership will call you to schedule an appointment. If you have not heard from your dealer within two working days, call your dealer to request a service appointment. You need do nothing else except bring your vehicle to the dealership on the service date.

If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service…

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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Ford Customer Service Division